

From Blank Page to Clear Story.

Today we will use AI as a presentation team: strategist, writer, designer, editor, and rehearsal coach. The goal is not more slides. The goal is a message people can understand and remember.

Free-first tools

Story before style

Prompt recipes

Human review

Today's mission

Create a short, audience-ready presentation using at least one AI planning tool and one slide-making tool.

A presentation is a guided decision, not a decorated document.

Weak starting point

"I need 12 slides about our project."

Better starting point

"After 8 minutes, this audience should understand the problem and approve the next step."

AI's role

Explore structure, draft alternatives, generate visuals, and speed up revisions.

Your role

Choose the truth, argument, examples, tone, and final call to action.

First question: What should the audience think, feel, or do differently?

Different tools solve different parts of the work.

Thinking partners

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini: clarify audience, story, slide copy, and speaker notes.

AI deck generators

Gamma, Canva, Pitch, Slidesgo, Prezi: turn prompts or outlines into designed drafts.

Source-grounded tools

NotebookLM: create a deck from selected sources and visible evidence.

Traditional editors + AI

PowerPoint Copilot and Gemini in Slides: build inside familiar slide editors.

Open-source generators

Presenton: generate editable PPTX/PDF with more privacy and technical control.

Most reliable workflow: plan in one tool, build in another, review yourself

● ● ● **START HERE | FREE-FIRST SHORTLIST**

Gamma

1 | **EASIEST TEST**

Free plan, starter AI credits

Fast prompt-to-deck workflow; imports PDF/PPTX; exports PDF, PPTX, PNG, and Google Slides. Free generation is limited.

No-card start

Up to 10 cards/prompt

Canva

2 | **FLEXIBLE EDITOR**

Free plan with limited AI usage

Magic Design creates a first draft, then Canva's editor and large template library make visual customization easy.

Free plan

Strong templates

Pitch

3 | **UNLIMITED DECKS**

Free plan; one-time AI credits

Create unlimited presentations, collaborate, and test the AI generator. Best for teams that want editable web-based decks.

Unlimited decks

Collaborative

Slidesgo AI

4 | **DOWNLOAD READY**

Free AI presentation maker

Generate from a topic, choose style and tone, edit online, and use outputs with Google Slides or PowerPoint.

Free start

Education friendly

Prezi AI

5 | **DYNAMIC FORMAT**

Free license includes AI credits

Useful when a zooming, non-linear visual journey fits the story. Continued or unlimited AI use may require upgrading.

Free credits

Distinctive motion

Presenton

6 | **PRIVACY/CONTROL**

Free and open source desktop app

Generate from prompts or documents, use custom templates, and export editable PPTX/PDF. Setup or an AI provider may be needed.

No subscription

Technical setup

● ● ● WORTH TESTING | TIME-LIMITED TRIALS

Beautiful.ai

14-day free trial; credit card required

Smart Slides automatically maintain layouts as content changes. Good for polished business slides and fast reformatting.

Full trial

Cancel before billing

Microsoft PowerPoint + Copilot

Microsoft 365 Premium one-month trial

Useful for people who need native PowerPoint editing, offline work, familiar templates, and organization-ready handoff.

1-month trial

PPTX native

Claude file creation / Claude Design

Capabilities depend on plan and availability

Claude can plan presentations and, on supported plans, create PowerPoint decks or polished visual slide work directly.

Strong reasoning

Check account access

Trial safety: check whether a card is required, set a cancellation reminder, export editable files, and never assume the same features will remain free.

● ● ● TOOL CHOICE | MATCH THE WORKFLOW

Your situation	Strong first choice	Why	Watch for
I need a beautiful first draft fast	Gamma or Canva	Prompt-to-deck plus quick visual themes	Generic claims, repeated layouts, branding
I need team collaboration	Pitch, Canva, or Google Slides	Comments, shared editing, web access	Permissions and version confusion
I must deliver editable PPTX	PowerPoint, Presenton, Gamma export	Native or exportable PowerPoint workflow	Exported layout may shift
I need a deck grounded in my sources	NotebookLM, then edit elsewhere	Starts from selected evidence	PDF-focused output and possible inaccuracies
I need privacy or local control	Presenton with approved/local model	Open-source, self-hosted option	Setup, model cost, and technical support
I need a memorable non-linear talk	Prezi	Zooming canvas supports spatial stories	Motion can distract or cause discomfort

Choose based on final delivery format, not only the prettiest demo

Strong decks are made through a sequence, not one magical prompt.

01

Define

Audience, purpose, decision, time.

02

Gather

Facts, examples, sources, brand assets.

03

Outline

One-sentence story and slide claims.

04

Draft

Generate slide content and notes.

05

Design

Choose layouts, visuals, and hierarchy.

06

Verify

Check facts, sources, readability, access.

07

Rehearse

Time the talk and improve transitions.

AI can assist at every step, but skipping a step usually creates a polished-looking weak presentation.

Give AI the presentation behind the presentation.

Audience

Who are they and what do they know?

Outcome

What should change after the talk?

Evidence

What facts or examples must appear?

Constraints

Time, slide count, tone, format.

Voice

What should sound like you?

One-minute brief

Audience: [WHO]
Purpose: [INFORM / PERSUADE / TEACH]
Afterward they should: [ACTION OR BELIEF]
Time: [MINUTES]
Must include: [FACTS / EXAMPLES]
Avoid: [JARGON / CLAIMS / TOPICS]
Final format: [PPTX / PDF / LINK]

Each slide should move the audience one step forward.

Why should we care?

What is happening now?

What does the evidence show?

What should we do?

What happens next?

Topic title

"Digital Skills Training"

Names a subject

Claim title

"A short weekly practice routine will improve adoption faster than one large training day."

Communicates the point

● ● ● PROMPT RECIPE | PLAN BEFORE DESIGNING

USE IN CHATGPT, CLAUDE, OR GEMINI Act as a presentation strategist. Help me plan a [LENGTH]-minute presentation for [AUDIENCE] about [TOPIC].

The audience currently believes or knows: [CONTEXT].

After the presentation, I want them to: [OUTCOME].

Use only these facts and sources: [PASTE OR ATTACH].

Tone: [TONE]. Constraints: [SLIDE COUNT / FORMAT / BRAND / ACCESSIBILITY].

First, propose a one-sentence thesis and a logical story arc. Then create a slide-by-slide plan. For every slide include:

1. a claim-style title,
2. the single idea it must prove,
3. the best evidence or example,
4. a suggested visual,
5. brief speaker notes,
6. anything that needs verification.

Do not invent facts. Identify weak or missing evidence before drafting.

Why this works

- Separates thinking from decoration.
- Makes every slide earn its place.
- Requests visuals and notes together.
- Surfaces missing evidence early.
- Creates a useful handoff to any slide generator.

Copy planning prompt

Outline

Create three alternative story arcs for this presentation: problem-solution, before-after, and question-answer. Recommend the strongest for my audience and explain why.

Slide copy

Rewrite this slide so it has one claim-style title, no more than 35 body words, one concrete example, and a clear visual suggestion. Preserve the factual meaning.

Red-team review

Critique this deck as a skeptical audience member. List the five biggest clarity, evidence, logic, and credibility problems. Then propose focused revisions without adding unsupported facts.

ChatGPT has a free plan

Strong for iterative conversation

Verify any generated claims

Best use: turning a vague idea into a testable story

Slide 11

Use Claude when the presentation must understand substantial source material.

Source synthesis

Upload approved material and ask for agreements, conflicts, gaps, and a source-based narrative.

Voice preservation

Provide a writing sample and request slide text and notes that preserve your natural tone.

File creation

On supported plans, request a PowerPoint deck; Claude Design may create visual slide work where available.

CLAUDE PROMPT Read the attached sources and build a concise presentation plan for [AUDIENCE]. Use XML-like sections in your response: <thesis>, <story_arc>, <slides>, <sources_by_slide>, and <open_questions>.

For each slide, distinguish source-backed statements from interpretation. Keep my voice: [DESCRIBE OR ATTACH SAMPLE]. If your account supports file creation, create an editable PowerPoint after I approve the outline. Otherwise, return a structured handoff for a slide generator.

Gemini in Slides

On eligible plans, generate or edit slides, create images, reference Drive files, and match the style of an existing presentation.

Create a new slide that explains [CLAIM] using [EVIDENCE]. Match this presentation's visual style. Use a simple comparison visual and no more than 30 words.

NotebookLM

Generate a detailed or presenter-style deck from selected sources. Useful when grounding matters more than open-ended creativity.

Create a presenter slide deck for [AUDIENCE] focused on [QUESTION]. Emphasize source disagreements, important evidence, and practical implications.

Google Slides

Free, familiar manual editor for collaboration and delivery. Gemini features require an eligible Google Workspace or Google AI plan.

Use the generated outline as a content guide, then manually apply the team's approved Slides theme and verify every source.

GAMMA CREATION PROMPT Create an 8-card presentation for [AUDIENCE] titled "[TITLE]."

Purpose: [OUTCOME].

Story arc: [PASTE APPROVED OUTLINE].

Use only these facts: [FACTS / SOURCES].

Visual direction: clean, confident, high contrast, minimal text, varied layouts, and meaningful diagrams instead of decorative images.

Each card must have one claim-style headline, one proof object, and brief supporting text. End with a specific next step. Do not invent statistics or quotations.

Strong Gamma workflow

1. Plan the outline first.
2. Generate from the approved outline.
3. Choose a restrained theme.
4. Replace generic images.
5. Shorten dense cards.
6. Export and inspect PPTX/PDF.

Copy Gamma prompt

Use Canva when learners want templates, visual assets, and easy editing in one place.

Start

Use Magic Design for Presentations with a focused topic prompt.

Customize

Apply an appropriate template, colors, typography, and media.

Collaborate

Share for comments and team editing.

Export

Check PDF/PPTX output and remove unavailable Pro assets.

CANVA PROMPT Design a clear [NUMBER]-slide presentation for [AUDIENCE] about [TOPIC]. The message is: [THESIS]. Use a [TONE] style with strong contrast, large readable text, simple diagrams, and consistent layouts. Include: opening hook, current situation, three key insights, one practical example, recommendations, and a final call to action. Avoid generic stock-photo layouts and unsupported facts.

Pitch

Best when a team wants a collaborative presentation workspace and unlimited presentations on the Free plan.

PITCH PROMPT Create a collaborative presentation for [AUDIENCE] that makes the case for [RECOMMENDATION]. Use this approved story arc: [OUTLINE]. Make every slide fully editable, vary layouts, and use evidence-led visuals. End with objections, responses, and the requested decision.

Free plan

One-time AI credits

Slidesgo AI

Best for fast classroom-friendly generation and compatibility with PowerPoint or Google Slides.

SLIDESGO PROMPT Generate a [FORMAL / CREATIVE / EDUCATIONAL] presentation about [TOPIC] for [AUDIENCE]. Focus on [THESIS], include [KEY SECTIONS], and use clear examples. Keep text concise and leave room for me to add verified facts and local examples.

Free AI maker

PPT/Slides compatible

Presenton is the strongest free option when control matters more than instant simplicity.

Free desktop app

No subscription or usage limit for the app itself.

Bring your model

Use supported AI providers or local models such as Ollama.

Use templates

Import PPTX templates and generate into a familiar style.

Export

Create editable PPTX and PDF outputs.

PRESENTON PROMPT

Create an editable PowerPoint presentation for [AUDIENCE] using the attached template and source document. Build [NUMBER] slides around this thesis: [THESIS]. Use the source document for facts, preserve the template's visual language, include speaker notes, and mark any missing evidence. Prefer diagrams, timelines, and comparisons over decorative imagery.

● ● ● STEP 3 | DESIGN A VISUAL SYSTEM



One dominant idea

The audience should know where to look first.

Large readable type

Slides support the speaker; they are not pages of a report.

Meaningful visual

Use a chart, process, example, or comparison that proves the title.

Consistent rules

Repeat fonts, colors, spacing, and footer behavior.

Varied layouts

Keep the system consistent without making every slide identical.

DESIGN DIRECTION PROMPT Revise the visual direction of this presentation for [AUDIENCE AND SETTING].

Use a restrained visual system:

- background: [LIGHT / DARK],
- typography: large, readable, and professional,
- palette: one primary accent plus one support color,
- layout: generous whitespace and varied compositions,
- visuals: diagrams, comparisons, charts, timelines, and authentic images only when they support the claim,
- accessibility: strong contrast, no meaning communicated by color alone, and readable labels.

Remove decorative clutter, repeated card grids, generic stock images, and paragraphs. Preserve all verified facts. Explain the design rule for each slide before applying it.

Do not ask only:

"Make it look professional."

Professional means different things for a classroom lesson, investor pitch, policy briefing, community proposal, and sales demo.

Copy design prompt

On the slide

1

CLAIM TITLE

1

PROOF OBJECT

1

TAKEAWAY

0

PARAGRAPHS

∞

CLARITY

Visible in seconds

In the speaker notes

NOTES PROMPT Write speaker notes for each slide that sound natural when spoken. For every slide include: a 10-second opening line, explanation of the visual, one concrete example, a transition to the next slide, and a factual caution if needed. Keep total speaking time under [MINUTES]. Do not simply read the slide text.

Copy notes prompt

Visual confidence can hide factual weakness.

Facts

Are numbers, names, dates, and quotations correct?

Sources

Does each important claim have real supporting evidence?

Logic

Does the evidence actually prove the slide title?

Visuals

Are charts honest, labels readable, and images appropriate?

Access

Can people read, hear, navigate, and understand it?

VERIFICATION PROMPT

Audit this presentation. Make a table with every factual claim, its slide number, the evidence provided, confidence level, and required verification action. Flag unsupported statistics, quotations, dates, causal claims, and images that may misrepresent the topic. Do not silently repair facts.

Human checks still required

- Open original sources.
- Inspect exports slide by slide.
- Confirm rights and privacy.
- Test links, video, and fonts.
- Ask a real person what is unclear.

● ● ● STEP 6 | USE AI AS A REHEARSAL COACH

Time it

Turn these speaker notes into a timed run-of-show for an 8-minute presentation. Mark slides that are likely to run long and propose cuts.

Prepare questions

Act as a skeptical member of [AUDIENCE]. Ask 12 likely questions, including three difficult objections. Draft concise evidence-based answers and flag where I lack evidence.

Simplify delivery

Rewrite these notes for natural spoken delivery. Shorten long sentences, explain jargon, preserve my meaning, and add clear transitions. Do not make the tone theatrical.

Final rehearsal rule: present aloud to a person, not only to AI.

AUDIENCE

school leaders

PURPOSE

persuade them to approve a proposal

TOPIC

a weekly AI practice lab

SLIDES

8

FINAL FORMAT

editable PowerPoint

TONE

clear and practical

MUST INCLUDE

the current problem, a simple plan, evidence, cost, risks, and next step

Build prompt

Act as a presentation strategist and slide designer.

Create a 8-slide presentation about a weekly AI practice lab for school leaders. The purpose is to persuade them to approve a proposal.

Requirements:

- Final format: editable PowerPoint
- Tone: clear and practical
- Must include: the current problem, a simple plan, evidence, cost, risks, and next step
- Start with a clear audience problem or question.
- Use a logical story arc and claim-style slide titles.
- Give every slide one main idea, one meaningful visual suggestion, concise visible text, and brief speaker notes.
- End with a specific call to action or next step.
- Use varied layouts, strong contrast, readable typography, and no decorative clutter.
- Do not invent facts, statistics, quotations, or sources. Mark anything that needs verification.

First show me the thesis and slide-by-slide outline for approval. Do not design the full deck until I approve the outline.

Copy generated prompt

Create the strategic brief

1. Choose a real topic.
2. Define audience and desired outcome.
3. Gather only safe, relevant source material.
4. Use the master planning prompt.
5. Approve or revise the thesis and story arc.

Time: 25 minutes

Visible output

Brief

Audience, outcome, constraints.

Thesis

One sentence the deck proves.

Outline

6-8 claim-style slide titles.

Evidence gaps

What still needs checking.

Compare tools instead of accepting the first output.

A

Free-first generator

Use Gamma, Canva, Pitch, Slidesgo, Prezi, or Presenton.

B

Alternative route

Try another generator or manually build from the approved outline.

C

Compare

Judge story, editability, visuals, export, speed, and hidden limitations.

Question	Draft A	Draft B
Which tells the clearest story?	—	—
Which is easiest to edit?	—	—
Which export works best?	—	—
What did each tool invent or misunderstand?	—	—

Time: 35 minutes

● ● ● HANDS-ON 3 | HUMAN EDITING SPRINT

Delete

Remove slides that repeat, distract, or fail to advance the story.

Sharpen

Turn every title into the message the audience should remember.

Prove

Add a source, example, diagram, or comparison that supports each claim.

Simplify

Reduce text and explain jargon in plain language.

Personalize

Add your voice, local context, authentic examples, and real next step.

FOCUSED REVISION PROMPT

Revise this deck while preserving the approved thesis and verified facts. Remove repetition, rewrite topic titles as claims, reduce visible text, replace generic visuals with meaningful proof objects, and strengthen the final call to action. List every factual change separately for human approval.

Review without explanation

1. Give the deck to a partner.
2. Do not explain the topic.
3. Partner writes the main message.
4. Partner marks the first confusing slide.
5. Partner names one missing question.
6. Creator makes one focused revision.

Time: 20 minutes

Score the deck from 1-5

Clear purpose and audience	—
Logical story	—
Readable slides	—
Credible evidence	—
Specific next step	—
Sounds like the presenter	—

Spend most of the session planning, comparing, editing, and rehearsing.

Time	Block	Visible output
00:00-00:25	Presentation purpose, tool families, and free-first tour	Tool-choice notes
00:25-00:55	Brief, thesis, story spine, and claim titles	Approved presentation outline
00:55-01:20	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, and planning prompts	Improved outline and evidence gaps
01:20-01:30	Break	Reset
01:30-02:05	Generate two drafts using free-first tools	Two comparable draft decks
02:05-02:45	Human editing and visual-system sprint	6-8 slide working presentation
02:45-02:55	Break	Reset
02:55-03:20	Verification, speaker notes, and export checks	Verified deck plus notes
03:20-03:45	Silent peer review and focused revision	Peer score and repaired deck
03:45-04:00	60-second presentations and reflection	Rehearsal evidence and next step

● ● ● ACCESS NOTES | CHECKED JUNE 15, 2026

Tool	Free/trial note used in this deck	Official source
Gamma	Free plan; starter credits; up to 10 cards per prompt; exports supported	gamma.app/pricing
Canva	Canva AI available on Free plan with usage limits	canva.com/canva-ai
Pitch	Free plan allows unlimited presentations; AI has one-time free credits	pitch.com / pitch.com/use-cases/ai-presentation-maker
Presenton	Desktop app is free and open source	presenton.ai/download
Slidesgo	Free AI Presentation Maker	slidesgo.com/ai/presentation-maker
Prezi	Free license includes AI credits; trial/upgrade for more access	prezi.com/features/ai
Beautiful.ai	14-day trial; credit card required	beautiful.ai/pricing
Microsoft 365	One-month Premium trial; Copilot in PowerPoint requires eligible access	microsoft.com/microsoft-365/try-copilot/individuals
Claude	File/PowerPoint creation and Claude Design depend on plan/availability	anthropic.com/news/create-files / anthropic.com/news/claude-design-anthropic-labs
Google	Gemini in Slides requires eligible plan; NotebookLM can generate slide decks	support.google.com/docs / support.google.com/notebooklm

Always re-check pricing, credits, export rules, and regional availability before training

The tool can make slides. You make the story worth following.

Define the outcome

Plan the story

Generate alternatives

Verify evidence

Edit with judgment

Rehearse aloud

Print / Save PDF

Exit ticket

1. Which tool fit your workflow best?
2. What did the AI-generated draft get wrong?
3. Which human edit improved the deck most?
4. What evidence still needs checking?
5. What will you do differently in your next presentation?